KenTender Module Guide: Procurement Planning

Oct 17, 2026

What Procurement Planning is for

Procurement Planning turns what departments say they will buy into one Annual Procurement Plan for the financial year. Each department puts forward its requirements. The Procurement Planner checks them and groups them into plan items, each tied to a strategic objective, a procurement method, a budget line and a value. The plan is then checked against the budget, confirmed by Finance, signed, adopted and approved by the statutory authority, published, and put in force.

The plan is the entity's mandate to buy. A requisition can draw only on an item in the approved plan, and only up to what the plan allows. It sits at the centre of the connected record, between the strategy and budget that sit above it and the requisitions and tenders that follow.

What it hands on: approved plan items, each with its objective, method, budget line and value, ready to be requisitioned.

Why it matters: one approved, affordable plan becomes the entity's mandate to buy, so compliance is built in from the start rather than checked afterwards. Unplanned or unaffordable purchases are stopped before they start, and the plan can be defended line by line.

Who uses it

Planning has the largest cast of any module, because a plan passes through preparation, review, funding, signature, adoption, statutory approval and publication. Each person does one clearly bounded job.

Who	What they do
Departmental Author	Prepares their department's plan: the accepted needs it will carry, any requirements the department adds directly, and the funding for each.
Head of User Department	Can prepare the department's plan and enter the department's own requirements directly. Certifies the plan, including what is included and what is left out this year, and submits it to Procurement.
Procurement Planner	Reviews each departmental plan, classifies its requirements, and groups them into plan items with an objective, method, schedule and budget line. Asks Finance to confirm funding, prepares updates and corrections, and records publication. Decides whether the plan in force keeps a need whose department has asked to withdraw it.
Head of Procurement Function	Signs and submits the complete annual plan to the Accounting Officer. This is the preparation signature, not an extra approval stage.
Finance Confirmation Officer	Confirms or returns the funding of the whole plan. Creates no reservation.
Accounting Officer	Adopts the plan and sends it to the statutory authority, or returns it. Can explain a late start, and can ask for an unpublished plan to be withdrawn for correction.
Statutory authority	The Cabinet Secretary or County Executive Committee Member, or the Board or Council as the entity's configuration says. Approves or returns the plan. Exactly one route applies.
Auditor and other authorised readers	Read the plan, its evidence and its history. Change nothing.
System administrators	Can read every record for support. Set up the approval route and other configuration in System setup.

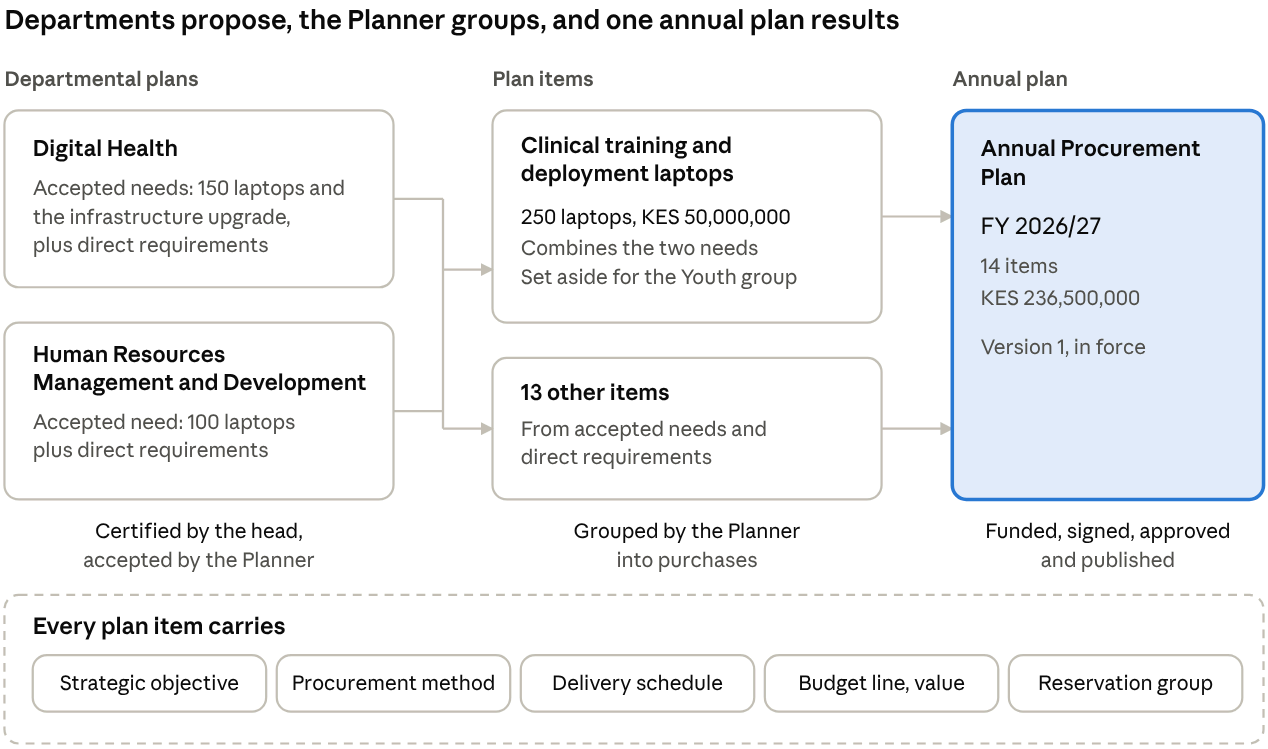
No one is trusted because of a title. Every action is checked against the person's current assignment and department. Several rules keep the chain honest:

- The person who certifies a departmental plan cannot accept or return it as Planner.
- Whoever prepared the plan, asked Finance to confirm it or signed it cannot also confirm funding, adopt it or approve it.
- Whoever confirmed or returned the funding cannot also adopt or approve.
- Whoever adopted the plan cannot also approve it.
- Recording that the plan was published is not a decision, so no such restriction applies to it.

These limits carry through every returned correction, so creating a new draft does not reset them.

How needs become the annual plan

Planning works in two layers. Each department first builds its own **departmental plan**. The Procurement Planner then turns the accepted departmental plans into the **plan items** of the single annual plan.



from departmental plans to the annual plan · Ministry of Health demonstration data

The departmental plan. It holds the accepted needs for the department and financial year, and any requirements the department's head enters directly. A direct requirement has the same facts as a need but no need behind it, and creates none. Each requirement carries a budget line and an indicative amount. For a need, that amount starts from the need's estimated cost, and the department may revise it. The plan shows the difference. A need the department will not pursue this year can be excluded with a written reason. It still counts as accounted for, and the accepted need itself is unchanged.

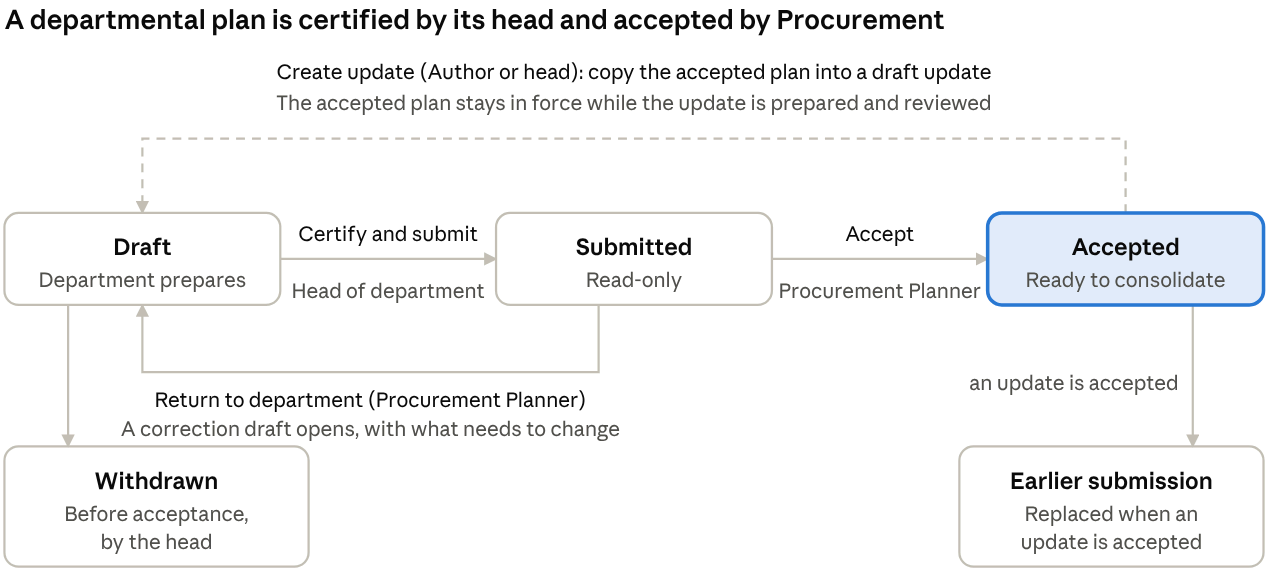
The plan items. The Planner chooses a requirement type for each proceeding requirement, and the system works out whether it is goods, works or services. The Planner then groups compatible requirements into plan items. Requirements can be grouped only if they share the financial year, budget line and currency, have compatible units, and have the same type and category. Several departments can contribute to one item, and grouping needs a written reason. Every requirement goes into an item whole, at its full quantity, so a need is never split, partly used or enlarged.

What each item carries. One strategic objective from the strategic plan that applies to the plan's financial year. A procurement method, with its conditions and evidence. A delivery schedule, which the system calculates from the method's rules. The basis of the cost estimate, such as a market survey. And the planned reservation group, if any, set aside for qualifying enterprises.

The first accepted departmental plan creates the first draft of the annual plan automatically, and the plan then grows as more departments are accepted. No department has to finish before others can proceed. After a department's plan is accepted, it can still prepare an update for changed or newly accepted requirements, which goes through the same certification and review.

The departmental plan's journey

A departmental plan is a draft until the head of department certifies and submits it. The Procurement Planner then accepts it or returns it. Each submission is numbered, and a certified submission never changes.



departmental plan lifecycle · four states, one return loop, one dashed update loop

The journey, step by step:

1. **Start.** The Author or the head starts the department's plan while the financial year is open for departmental plans. Starting creates the plan and its first draft. Merely opening a page creates nothing.
2. **Prepare.** The department accounts for every accepted need it has for that year, either by planning it with a budget line and indicative amount or by excluding it with a reason. It adds any direct requirements. A plan cannot be submitted until every accepted need is accounted for.
3. **Certify and submit.** The head certifies, with a statement that names the department and the financial year and covers everything included and everything left out. The submission is then fixed, and one review task is opened for the Planner.
4. **Review.** The Planner sees the whole certified plan and chooses a requirement type for each requirement that is proceeding. The category (goods, works or services) follows from the type. The person who certified the plan cannot review it.
5. **Accept or return.** *Accept* makes the proceeding requirements available for consolidation into plan items, records the exclusions with their reasons, and tells Departmental Needs what happened to each need. *Return* needs a written statement of what needs to change, tied to an entry or to the whole plan. The department then gets a correction draft.

6. **Correct.** The head can resubmit a returned plan, but only for the same requirements. A correction can bring in the latest accepted version of a need it covered. It cannot be used to add unrelated requirements after the window has closed.
7. **Update.** Once a plan is accepted, the department can create an update for changed requirements, newly accepted needs or new direct requirements. The accepted plan stays in force. The update goes through the same certification and review, and replaces the earlier submission only when accepted.

A need that is accepted after its department's plan was accepted is not lost. The department's page, the Planning workspace and the need's own page all say it is the department's turn to create an update that adds it.

If the Planner finds later that a requirement was classified wrongly, they record a **classification correction** with a reason. It adds a new record. The accepted decision is never edited, and a plan already in use keeps what it was approved with.

The annual plan's journey

The plan the Planner builds is a draft until it has passed through seven stages. At each one a named holder either moves it on or returns it. The plan is in force only at the end.

An annual plan passes seven stages before it is in force

Stage	Who holds it	What happens
1 Preparation	Procurement Planner	Groups items, then asks Finance to confirm
2 Funding confirmation	Finance Confirmation Officer	Confirms or returns the whole plan's funding
3 Signature	Head of Procurement Function	Signs and submits the exact plan
4 Adoption	Accounting Officer	Adopts and sends it on, or returns it
5 Statutory approval	Statutory authority	Approves it, or returns it
6 Publication	Procurement Planner	Records Treasury submission and web publication
7 In force	No one: it is the baseline	Requisitions can now draw on its items

A return at adoption or approval opens a correction draft back at Preparation.
A return from Funding confirmation keeps the plan in Draft, still open to editing.

annual plan lifecycle · seven stages

A few things about how it behaves:

- **Funding confirmation is not approval.** The plan stays a draft while Finance reviews it, and the Planner can keep editing. A change that alters the money on any budget line cancels an open review or makes a completed confirmation stale. A change that leaves every line's amount the same does not.
- **Signature is not an extra approval.** It records who prepared the exact plan. The Head of Procurement Function signs it, not the Planner, and the Planner who prepared it cannot go on to confirm funding, adopt or approve.
- **Stage 5 always applies.** Exactly one statutory route is configured: Cabinet Secretary, County Executive Committee Member, Board or Council. A Board or Council records its collective resolution and who recorded it, not a vote by each member. A plan cannot be submitted if the route is missing or unclear.
- **A return always has a reason.** Returning needs a written, actionable reason, and returning is allowed even when the evidence has gone stale, because that is often why the plan is being returned. The reviewed version is kept as it was and a new correction

draft is opened.

- **Publication happens outside KenTender.** The entity submits the approved plan to the National Treasury and publishes it on its own website. The Planner then records both facts in one action, *Confirm plan publication*, with the evidence of each. This records what has been done and approves nothing. The system then runs its usual checks and puts the plan in force. If a check fails, the plan reads *Published, activation held*, shows the specific blocker, and offers *Prepare a corrected plan*.
- **A defect before publication.** If a material defect is found before publication is confirmed, the Accounting Officer can ask for the approved plan to be withdrawn for correction, and the statutory authority does so. Once publication is confirmed, a correction goes through a new version.

An approved plan is never edited. To change one that is in force, the Planner prepares an **update**: a copy that goes through the same seven stages. The plan in force carries on, with its requisitions, until the update replaces it, and the allowances already used carry across to the new version.

The checks a plan must pass

A plan can be drafted incomplete, but it cannot move on until it passes its checks. The screen lists every failing check together, each with a way to fix it, rather than revealing them one at a time.

Check	What it asks	What it holds back
Strategic objective	Every item names exactly one objective from the strategic plan that applies to the plan's financial year. At approval, Strategy records an unchangeable copy of the objective and its path.	Asking Finance to confirm funding
Budget fit	For each budget line, the planned total must not exceed the line's approved amount. Being over what is available right now is only advice.	Asking Finance, Finance's confirmation, and signing. The fix is to reduce a purchase or to ask the Budget Officer for a revision.

Check	What it asks	What it holds back
Procurement method	Every item has a method, with its conditions and evidence. Its schedule is worked out from the method's rules, and delivery must finish by the earliest date any source asked for.	Asking Finance (a missing method). Signing (a method whose rules are not verified or are incomplete).
Finance confirmation	The funding of the whole plan is confirmed against the budget lines. It reserves nothing and is separate from approval.	Signing
Reserved share	The part of the plan set aside for qualifying enterprises must meet the required target.	Signing only, so the funding check and the fix can proceed in parallel
Complete plan	At least one purchase is proceeding, and every accepted need has been planned or excluded with a reason.	Asking Finance and signing

Two of these deserve a closer look.

The reserved share. The target is a percentage of the eligible value of the whole annual plan: a share of what the entity plans to buy, not of its budget. Money in the budget that the plan does not use does not raise the target.

In the demonstration plan the eligible value is KES 236,500,000, so the 30% target requires KES 70,950,000. Two items are designated for qualifying groups: the laptops at KES 50,000,000 and the core network routers at KES 25,000,000. That is KES 75,000,000, or 31.71%, so the target is met. This measures what is planned, not what is later bought. The demonstration uses a fixture rule, labelled as not production law, until the legal rule is verified. A justification never waives a mandatory allocation.

Method and schedule. Choosing a method shows its specific conditions and the evidence it needs. A declaration that needs judgement is reviewed in the plan's normal governance and is never treated as proven. Nothing can be bypassed by narrative. The plan covers a single financial year, and a splitting warning prompts the Planner to assess whether related purchases have been split to avoid a limit. It never waives a mandatory limit.

What the rest of the system takes from the plan

The plan in force is the one baseline that other modules rely on. Planning gives each of them facts, and takes facts back, without reaching into their records.

Who	What passes
Requisitions	An item in the plan in force is what a requisition draws on. Only one requisition can be open for an item at a time. When a requisition is authorised, Planning records the draw against the item's remaining allowance in the same step that Budget makes the reservation. A requisition may finish earlier than the plan's boundary but never later.
Budget	Planning reads the lines open to each department and each plan's affordability. It can ask the Budget Officer for a revision. It never reserves, releases or changes a budget amount.
Strategy	The objective picked for each item. At approval, Strategy records a fixed copy of it, which the plan keeps even if the strategy later changes.
Departmental Needs	Whether each need is in the plan in force, whether the department's plan accepted or excluded it, and whose turn it is when the plan must be updated to carry a new need. When a need's withdrawal is blocked because it is in the plan in force, the Procurement Planner gets a work item to decide whether the plan keeps it.
Tenders	When a tender is invited, Planning receives the actual invitation date from the module that owns that event. It shows the actual date beside the approved baseline, for each tender separately. Nobody can type an actual date into Planning.
Reporting and Analytics	Planning's own facts, such as how much planned value is covered by authorised requisitions. Award, supplier, delivery and payment facts stay with their owners.

Who	What passes
The public	The approved plan's files, a web page, a PDF and a data file all produced from the same approved copy, which the entity publishes on its own website. KenTender itself has no public page in this release.

The scope lock. The first time a requisition is authorised for an item, the item's scope is fixed for good, through every later version of the plan. A new need for more of the same goods cannot be added to that item, even after its tender is published. It forms a separate item in a plan update, goes through the same governance, and gets its own requisition. The original tender keeps its original quantity and value, and nothing in the system presents it as covering the later need.

Corrections from downstream. If Requisitions finds a problem in a plan item, it records a correction request. New requisitions against that item are held until the Planner resolves it with a corrected plan in force, or closes it with a reason. Existing requisitions and published tenders are untouched, and a stopped requisition never restarts on its own. An approved plan in force is never edited directly: a change always goes through an update.

Safeguards

- **Authority comes from assignment.** Every action is checked against the person's current assignment and department, and a department sees only its own evidence. A title alone grants nothing.
- **Separation of duties holds throughout.** The separation rules in the roles section carry through every returned correction.
- **Every accepted need is accounted for.** A departmental plan cannot be submitted until each accepted need is planned or excluded with a reason, and every requirement goes into one item whole.
- **Over-budget plans stop.** A budget line planned above its approved amount stops the plan going to Finance, being confirmed or being signed. Funding confirmation reserves nothing.
- **Approved means fixed.** Once signed, the plan's content is locked and an approved plan is never edited. A change is an update that passes the same stages, while the plan in force carries on with its requisitions and balances.

- **Nothing comes into force by default.** A plan comes into force once, and only when every check passes. A plan that is published but held gives no one the right to requisition.
- **History is kept.** Decisions, signatures, snapshots and published files are only added to, each with who acted, in which role and when. Actual dates come only from the module that owns the event.